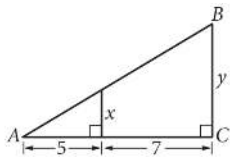


Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Geometry and Trigonometry	Lines, angles, and triangles	Hard

Question



Note: Figure not drawn to scale.

The area of triangle ABC above is at least 48 but no more than 60. If y is an integer, what is one possible value of x ?

Rationale

The correct answer is either $\frac{10}{3}$, $\frac{15}{4}$, or $\frac{25}{6}$. The area of triangle ABC can be expressed as $\frac{1}{2}(5+7)y$ or $6y$. It's given that the area of triangle ABC is at least 48 but no more than 60. It follows that $48 \leq 6y \leq 60$. Dividing by 6 to isolate y in this compound inequality yields $8 \leq y \leq 10$. Since y is an integer, $y = 8, 9, \text{ or } 10$. In the given figure, the two right triangles shown are similar because they have two pairs of congruent angles: their respective right angles and angle A. Therefore, the following proportion is true: $\frac{x}{y} = \frac{5}{12}$. Substituting 8 for y in the proportion results in $\frac{x}{8} = \frac{5}{12}$. Cross multiplying and solving for x yields $\frac{10}{3}$. Substituting 9 for y in the proportion results in $\frac{x}{9} = \frac{5}{12}$. Cross multiplying and solving for x yields $\frac{15}{4}$. Substituting 10 for y in the proportion results in $\frac{x}{10} = \frac{5}{12}$. Cross multiplying and solving for x yields $\frac{25}{6}$. Note that 10/3, 15/4, 25/6, 3.333, 3.75, 4.166, and 4.167 are examples of ways to enter a correct answer.